

up with the button “Get Started Now”. Click on this to open up a wizard that creates your first DynamoDB table.

- The first screen on the wizard requires you to enter a name for the table and a primary key. The primary key is used to hash the data across hosts for scalability. Keep the default settings check box checked as it allows for minimal configuration for the table. Note that the dialog box below it says that auto scaling is not enabled by default, this can be overridden by changing the default settings. Click on ‘Create’ to create the table.
- The table is now created and you are redirected to the tables list. To check the items of the table open the ‘Items’ tab and search the items by typing in a query and clicking ‘Start search’.

To connect to DynamoDB table you can use one of the available SDKs for the popular languages available on AWS.

ElastiCache

Although frequently accessed data was traditionally stored in databases (relational or otherwise) the usual latency for disk-based operations associated with most databases became a blocker for some high throughput applications in recent years. This led to the rise of ‘in-memory databases’, a class of databases that store (most) data in-memory instead of on disks allowing for much lower latencies.

Nowadays, most highly available and fluid applications use in-memory databases in one way or another (usually to cache some data, ticker updates etc). Just like traditional databases, amazon also offers a managed variant of the two most popular in-memory databases Redis & Memcached.

Let us take a look at how to setup a Redis engine on ElastiCache.

Setting up ElastiCache:

- Open the “Services” tab from the AWS Console and navigate to ‘ElastiCache’ under Databases. This should open up the ElastiCache Console and default to the ‘Tables’ list. It lists all the created ElastiCache instances, click on any of them to view their details. If there are none, an additional popup introducing ElastiCache opens up with the button “Get Started Now”. Click on this to open up a wizard that creates your first ElastiCache in-memory database.
- The on screen wizard requires you to select either Redis or Memcached as the underlying in-memory database engine, here choose the Redis engine and then select a name for the cluster.